

Matthew Eaton

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Economics of Crime, Economics of Education, Applied Microeconomics

Education

Ph.D. in Economics Aug. 2022 to Present

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

Fields: Labor Economics, Public Economics

M.S. in Applied Economics Aug. 2019 to May 2020

Marquette University

Milwaukee, WI

Specialization: Business Analytics

B.A. in Economics and Political Science Aug. 2016 to May 2019

Marquette University

Milwaukee, WI

Concentration: Political Economy

Professional Experience

Economist Nov. 2020 to July 2022

U.S. Department of Labor, Bureau of Labor Statistics, Office of Price and Living Conditions, Producer Price Index

Washington D.C.

Associate Educational Research Scientist Aug. 2020 to Nov.2020

U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Educational Sciences, National Center for Education Statistics

Washington D.C.

Institutional Research Assistant Aug. 2018 to June 2020

Marquette University, Office of Research and Institutional Advancement (OIRA)

Milwaukee, WI

Teaching Experience

Instructor Fall 2024 to Present

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

- Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Summer 2026, Fall 2026)

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2022 to Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026

Clemson University

Clemson, SC

- Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall 2022 to Summer 2024, Summer 2026)
- Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2023)
- Sports Economics (Spring 2023)
- Principles of Macroeconomics (Spring 2024)
- Environmental Economics (Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026)
- Government and Business (Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026)

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2019 to Spring 2020

Marquette University

Milwaukee, WI

- Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2019 – Spring 2020)

*Current Research***Job Market Paper****Eaton, M., Dunagan N., & Stalvey B.** "The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Crime and Community Outcomes in Philadelphia"

Focused Deterrence is a crime-reduction strategy that combines an increased probability and severity of punishment with direct communication of consequences to individuals identified as likely offenders. Philadelphia implemented Focused Deterrence in 2013 in response to rising gun violence. We estimate this policy's effects on crime rates as well as community downstream effects on rental pricing and housing valuations. Using a standard difference-in-difference design, we find that the number of shooting victims declined by 41.3 percent and gun crime incidents fell by 24.2 percent. Total reported crime incidents declined by roughly 13.8 percent, reflecting reductions in both violent and non-violent offenses. This reduction in crime resulted in increases in rental prices between 6.0 to 7.5 percent, and housing values from 3.6 to 7.0 percent. Together, these findings suggest that Focused Deterrence's crime-reduction effects extend beyond its direct targets, and that this broader improvement in neighborhood safety is capitalized into local housing and rental markets.

*Working Papers***Eaton, M. & Banerjee, S.** "Involuntary Part-Time Employment, Gig Rollout, and the Flexibility of Work" (Under Review at *Labour Economics*)

The Great Recession saw not only high unemployment, but also a sharp rise in involuntary part-time employment—workers seeking full-time work but finding only limited part-time hours. The involuntary part-time employment rate declined gradually throughout the mid-to-late 2010s, a period that coincided with the rapid expansion of gig employment. This paper examines whether the introduction of UberX, a major ride-hailing platform, causally reduced involuntary part-time work in metropolitan area labor forces. We utilize the geographic and temporal rollout of UberX across metropolitan areas to estimate causal effects via a staggered Difference-in-Differences strategy. Our results indicate that UberX entry reduces involuntary part-time employment as a share of the total labor force by 10 percent and as a fraction of total

part-time employment by 8.7 percent. We find little evidence of other labor market flows during this period, suggesting that UberX serves as a mechanism for workers to transition from involuntary to voluntary part-time employment.

Bullard, M., Eaton M., & Lambert, M. "When the Mines Close: Coal Employment Shocks and Family Health Impacts in Appalachia"

This paper investigates how coal mining employment in Appalachia affects health outcomes across different populations within mining-dependent counties. Using the substitution from coal to natural gas in electricity generation as an exogenous shock to coal demand beginning in the late 2000s, we construct a shift-share instrumental variable that exploits county-level variation in baseline coal dependence. We find that mining employment increases deaths of despair among working-age men, driven entirely by drug poisoning deaths, consistent with occupational exposure to prescription opioids. Mining employment also worsens reproductive health. We observe increases in fetal deaths, low birth weights, and preterm births associated with increased mining activity. However, a tradeoff emerges. Mining employment decline harms populations outside the workforce. We observe a decrease in birth rates as well as increases in deaths of despair among children and the elderly, also driven by drug poisonings. Comparing Appalachian to non-Appalachian coal counties reveals that the observed poisoning pathway is unique to Appalachia and not to coal mining itself. Our results suggest that Appalachian coal counties face competing health costs from both mining employment and its decline, with the burden falling on different members of the community.

Eaton, M. "First-Generation and College Choice"

This paper investigates the relationship between parental education and college matching decisions. First-generation college students more often face challenges in the college application process such as lack of college preparation coursework, lack of financial support to fund postsecondary education, and lack of guidance in applying and choosing which institution to attend. Using the High School Longitudinal Study of 2009, this paper investigates whether first-generation college students are more prone to academically mismatch with their college attended compared to non-first-generation college students. An academic match is the comparison of a student's placement in the academic ability distribution and their institution's placement on the college quality distribution. This paper seeks to contribute to the growing college matching literature and to shed light on the role of parental education in the match quality between student and institution attended.

Stalvey, B. & Eaton, M. "Abortion Access and Institutional Demand for Higher Education: Evidence from Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization"

The June 2022 Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization decision returned abortion policy to the states, producing the sharpest change in the geography of American abortion access in half a century. We ask how this shock propagated into the market for four-year undergraduate education, using 894 public and private not-for-profit institutions over 2010–2024 and a two-way fixed-effects event study comparing institutions in persistent-ban states to those in never-ban states. Across the application margin, where prior work using elite or high-achieving subsamples has identified declines, we estimate consistent nulls in both sectors: applications, admissions, and the gender

composition of applicants do not respond to the bans. The first margin at which we detect a response is enrollment, and it moves in the opposite direction from the dominant health-care-amenity prediction: first-time full-time enrollment rises by roughly 3–10 percent at ban-state institutions relative to never-ban controls, across both genders and both sectors. The application-margin findings of prior work do not generalize beyond the elite slice, and the institution-level demand response to Dobbs is, on net, positive.

Eaton, M. & Dunagan, N. "Judicial Bias in Capital Sentencing in Early 20th Century South Carolina"

This paper investigates whether racial disparities existed in capital sentencing in South Carolina during the early twentieth century. We construct a novel dataset by digitizing the Report of the Attorney General to the General Assembly of South Carolina and county Criminal Journals, allowing us to observe capital case outcomes at a level of geographic and temporal detail not previously available for this period. Our empirical strategy exploits the rotation of judges across judicial circuits, which effectively randomized the assignment of judges to counties at different points in the year, generating plausibly exogenous variation in the judge presiding over a given capital case. Focusing on murder and rape—the principal capital offenses of the period—we examine whether sentencing outcomes varied systematically with the race of the defendant, and whether the race of the victim, and the interaction between defendant and victim race, further shaped these outcomes. By situating this analysis within an era of widespread societal discrimination, the paper contributes historical context to the ongoing discussion of judicial decision-making and racial disparities in the American criminal justice system.

Eaton, M. & Laha, M. "The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Education Outcomes in Philadelphia"

Research Presentations

Southern Economic Association 96th Fall 2026
 "The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Crime and Community Outcomes in Philadelphia"
 Houston, TX

Clemson Labor Economics Workshop Spring 2026
 "When the Mines Close: Coal Employment Shocks and Family Health Impacts in Appalachia"
 Clemson, SC

Clemson Labor Economics Workshop Fall 2025
 "The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Crime and Community Outcomes in Philadelphia"
 Clemson, SC

Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting Fall 2025
 "Impact of Employment Shocks on Health Outcomes: Evidence from Appalachia"
 Tampa, FL

Clemson Labor Economics Workshop Spring 2025
 "Involuntary Part-Time Employment, Gig Rollout, and the Flexibility of Work"
 Clemson, SC

Clemson Labor Economics Workshop "Involuntary Part-Time Employment, Gig Rollout, and the Flexibility of Work" Clemson, SC	Fall 2024
Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting "Involuntary Part-Time Employment, Gig Rollout, and the Flexibility of Work" "First-Generation and College Choice" Washington, DC	Fall 2024
Clemson Labor Economics Workshop "First-Generation and College Choice" Clemson, SC	Spring 2024
Clemson Applied Theory Reading Group "Involuntary Part-Time Employment, Gig Rollout, and the Flexibility of Work" Clemson, SC	Spring 2024
Clemson Labor Economics Workshop "First-Generation and College Choice" Clemson, SC	Fall 2023

Awards & Honors

Dr. Robert T. Tollison Fellowship <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2025 to Present
Price Theory Summer Camp Attendant <i>University of Chicago - Becker Friedman Institute for Economics</i>	Summer 2025
Clemson University Graduate Student Government Travel Grant <i>Clemson University - Graduate Student Government</i>	2024 - 2026
Best 2nd-year Paper <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2023-2024
Clemson University Department of Economics Graduate Assistantship <i>Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics</i>	2022 to Current
Marquette University Graduate Assistantship <i>Marquette University - Department of Economics</i>	2019 to 2020
Marquette University Klinger Arts and Sciences Explorer Scholarship <i>Marquette University - College of Arts and Sciences</i>	2016 to 2019
Marquette University Pere Marquette Scholarship <i>Marquette University</i>	2016 to 2019

Specialized Skills

Technical: R, STATA, SAS, Python, SQL, GIS Training, L^AT_EX, Bloomberg Terminal Training, Tableau, Qualtrics, Microsoft Office Suite

References

Devon Gorry

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